



MONTHLY UPDATE

Djibouti: monthly update, July – August 2026

Edition of 2026-08-27 · 19 systems and instruments tracked

Developments summarised from sources published between the beginning of last month and today.

SUMMARY OF THE MONTH · GOVERNANCE · ICT INFRASTRUCTURE · DPI · TECHNOLOGY · CAPACITY · DATA

Summary of the month

The month's largest item is a memorandum. On 19 July 2026 Djibouti and the Chinese LinkWise Group [signed a protocole d'accord](#) stated at US\$1.35bn for a 100 MW AI compute centre, up to 500 MW of renewable generation and an AI special economic zone; four days later the signing minister [set out its terms on the record](#), including 1,000 hectares of land, guaranteed seawater abstraction for cooling, a policy-stability clause and a tax-exemption period.

Two accounts of the state's own records followed in early August: one [describes 126 years of the Journal officiel published online](#), the other [police body cameras in routine use](#) with no published instrument governing the footage.

The month closed on the policy side of the same subject: the [national AI strategy is to be launched at a first national forum on 2-3 September](#), running to 2032 on eight axes, alongside a readiness assessment that scores the country 24.5 out of 100.

Governance

Strategies, plans and policies

At WSIS 2026 in Geneva on 9 July the communications minister [restated Vision Djibouti 2035 as the frame for a regional technology hub](#) and [sought ITU and Smart Africa support for public-service digitalisation and AI capacity](#). No instrument resulted.

The artificial-intelligence strategy acquired a launch date rather than a text. The digital economy ministry [announced the country's first national AI forum for 2-3 September 2026 at Djibouti-Ville, with an AI village at the Palais du Peuple](#), framed around a young generation of Djiboutian developers and researchers entering the field. The strategy is stated as complete and set to launch there; its content is still unpublished, so what the month adds is a date and an audience.

Data protection

On 4 August 2026 the state daily *La Nation* [described the Police Nationale and road-safety officers carrying body-worn cameras routinely in central Djibouti](#), not piloting them. The protocols it reports require the device to be worn visibly and the subject to be told they are being recorded, with recording triggered manually or automatically according to the type of intervention or the threat level detected. No retention period, access rule, data controller or authorising instrument is named, and nothing on file establishes one as at 4 August 2026. The Digital Code's prior-authorisation regime, in force since 30 June 2025, reaches biometric processing, and no authorisation or published rule covering the camera fleet is held.

ICT Infrastructure

Connectivity

On 3 August 2026 the Italian foundation Med-Or reported that a [project promoted by Italy's foreign ministry with Med-Or is building the Djiboutian authorities' capability to inspect and protect the submarine cables](#), under a memorandum with the Ministry of Economy and Finance covering critical infrastructure, digital connectivity and strategic dialogue. [Med-Or's figures put 12 cables landing in Djibouti, six connected to Italy, and about 18% of international submarine cable data transiting the country](#). No amount, term or delivery date is stated and the memorandum is not held.

On 29 July the new communications minister [received Japan's ambassador and the UN resident coordinator in succession](#), covering audiovisual media re-equipment, journalist training against disinformation, and the strategic weight of the cables. No agreement was signed and no figure was given.

Data Storage

On 19 July 2026 the state signed a memorandum of understanding with the Shanghai-based LinkWise Group, [stated at US\\$1.35bn and carried in full by the investor with no state equity and no sovereign debt](#), for a 100 MW AI compute centre, a digital industrial park and international data corridors, valid one year. In [an interview published on 23 July](#) the minister-delegate for investment gave the terms: 1,000 hectares of land, guaranteed seawater abstraction for cooling, a policy-stability clause presented as a legal guarantee of long-term investor return, a tax-exemption period before revenue accrues to the state, technical training in place of local employment quotas, and cryptographic compute in the revenue model alongside AI. The preparatory phase runs six months from signature; nothing is disbursed and no site is held. The 100 MW figure is the promoters' own.

Energy

The same 19 July memorandum with LinkWise commits [up to 500 MW of solar, wind and storage generation](#) to power the AI compute zone — a figure the promoters supply.

Cybersecurity

The national incident response team took part in the IGAD regional cybersecurity exercise from 26 to 30 June, and the state daily reported that [the ANC's team placed first in both simulation scenarios](#). The exercise organiser has published no result, so the placing rests on that single account. It is the only cybersecurity movement the base records for Djibouti in the period.

DPI

Data Exchange

The same [23 July account names an ID Mobile credential, an online services portal and real-time card verification for banks and social-protection bodies as in preparation](#), with staffing and archive space named as the constraints. No date is given for any of them.

Digital Identity and CRVS

Two interviews of 23 July 2026 put the identity stack on the record in detail. The Direction générale de la Population et de la Famille [enrols fingerprints, iris, photograph and electronic signature into the Registre national des personnes physiques and issues each citizen a national identification number](#); its director-general states the card has been issued nationwide since 2025 and that mobile kits reach the elderly, the hospitalised and remote populations.

Automatic comparison against the national base is returning duplicate registrations, birth-date contradictions decades old, and people who have lived their administrative lives under a dead person's identity; those cases go to the parquet for judicial regularisation.

Registries

The same 23 July account reports [birth, marriage and death archives being digitised in parallel](#) with the identity-stack work above, staffing and archive space again the named constraints and no date given.

Other GovTech and e-Gov

On 2 August 2026 the Secrétariat général du Gouvernement and UNDP [signed a letter of accord to digitise the SGG's paper archives](#) — indexing, scanning, capacity building for national teams, and secure backup at the ANSIE data centre. [It follows a state-funded programme running since 2023 which the parties report has transferred several thousand archive boxes to the National Archives and produced over 200,000 secured digital files for the Presidency.](#) From September 2026 it extends to the audit and integrity institutions — the Chambre des Comptes, the two financial inspectorates, the anti-corruption commission, the public accounts directorate and the human-rights commission. The accord's text, value and duration are not stated.

Technology

AI

On 17 July an upgraded AI weather early-warning system was [handed over at the World AI Conference in Shanghai](#). Version 2.0 adds observation and autonomous alerting through smart terminals combining satellite, ground data and forecast models, and sharpens forecast resolution to 3 km from 9 km. The first system was supplied by the China Meteorological Administration in July 2025 and entered service in December 2025.

The LinkWise interview of 23 July also [named a cross-border data corridor linking Shanghai to Djibouti among the arrangement's success indicators, alongside full Djiboutian jurisdiction over data natively generated on the territory](#), with chips specified as NVIDIA H and B series. The memorandum text is not held; the terms are the minister's account.

The national AI strategy that has been in preparation since January acquired a launch date and a shape. It is [to be launched officially at Djibouti's first national AI forum on 2-3 September at the Palais du Peuple](#), carried by the digital economy ministry and the Secretariat General of the Government with UNESCO and UN ESCWA support, and runs to 2032 on eight axes: ethical AI governance, data and digital infrastructure, education and human capital, economy and employment, social inclusion and gender, strategic sectors, responsible technological infrastructure, and international cooperation. The ministry [convened cross-ministerial focal points on 15 August](#) to coordinate it.

The forum will also present the national readiness assessment behind the strategy, which puts Djibouti at [24.5 out of 100 on AI readiness against an ICT development index of 61.6](#) — the gap the strategy is written against, and one the account attributes to the submarine cables landing in Djibouti and the data centres built around them. Neither the assessment report nor the strategy text is held.

Innovation ecosystem

On 4 July 2026 the Ministry Delegate for the Digital Economy and Innovation [launched the LIMO platform](#), described by the ministry as support for entrepreneurship and for access to opportunities by startups and developers. The account is a trade-press report of the ministry's announcement, no user or service figures are published, and it is a distinct system from the private marketplace of the same name.

Capacity

Training and skills

Against unemployment, the state is [using digital channels to connect graduates with recruiters](#). The account names no platform, no registration count and no placement figure, so what is held is a stated direction rather than a measurable one. It is read here alongside the [spring economic monitor](#), whose school-to-work analysis is the closest thing the base holds to a measure of the problem the initiative is written against.

Data

Open data

The account of the archive programme published on 3 August also [establishes that 126 years of the Journal officiel are digitised and published online](#). The account gives no date for when publication began.

ABOUT THIS DOCUMENT

EDITION	2026-08-27
CURRENT EDITION	https://corpus.data-landscapers.io/reports/DJI/DJI-monthly.html
THIS FILE	https://corpus.data-landscapers.io/reports/DJI/DJI-monthly-2026-08-27.pdf
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